

SECOND INNINGS

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OR ALMOST TWO years, the work remained known only to a small circle of people.

There were no product announcements, fund-raising rounds or launch events. The work began at Continue Research, which describes itself as “neither a company nor a start-up”, but a research organisation. It was trying to answer a simple question: if the human body is a system, where are its most important leverage points?

36 | The research focused on ageing, cerebral blood flow and the biology of longevity.

Then, in November last year, Deepinder Goyal appeared wearing a small metallic device clipped to his right temple.

Doctors questioned the science while biohackers speculated about what it measured. Eventually, Goyal revealed that the device—Temple—had grown out of Continue Research’s work on ageing and that he had been wearing prototypes for nearly a year.

In the months since, Temple, still very much in development, has expanded its invite-only testing programme to around 100 volunteers. Investors have committed \$54 million (around ₹500 crore) to the venture, including \$11.5 million from Goyal himself, valuing it at \$190 million.

The fundraise came just weeks after Goyal stepped down as the Chief Executive Officer and Man-

As consumer internet matures and markets consolidate, experienced entrepreneurs are finding bigger opportunities in sectors that barely existed a decade ago

Consumer start-up founders say their second ventures are driven less by financial ambition and more by the desire to solve harder problems and build enduring businesses

Investors are backing these ventures early, betting that experienced founders bring capital, pattern recognition and execution skills that first-time entrepreneurs lack

Second-time founders are carrying forward lessons in scaling organisations, building brands and managing complexity, even as they enter entirely new industries

AI is reducing the cost of building companies, making it easier for seasoned entrepreneurs to pursue ideas that were previously impractical



aging Director of Eternal, the parent company of Zomato and Blinkit, which he co-founded in 2008.

Temple is an unlikely second act. The founder who spent nearly two decades building one of India’s defining consumer internet companies is now trying to build a neuroscience company. But Temple isn’t the only thing Goyal is building.

Last year, he also co-founded LAT Aerospace, an aviation venture aiming to transform regional connectivity in India using autonomous, hybrid-electric aircraft designed for short runways. In February this year, it acquired Gurugram-based defence robotics start-up Sharang Shakti.

Goyal declined to comment on this story. However, he has said in previous interviews that he briefly experimented with what he called an “unpurposeful life.”

“It was enjoyable for a few months, but at its core it was shallow and hollow, and it wasn’t for me. So, I came back to work,” he said.

Goyal is part of a growing group of first-generation tech entrepreneurs who are rolling up their sleeves again and starting something new—something very different. Aman Gupta, after building boAt, is now working on OffBeat Studios, a talent management and creative agency. In April, it raised ₹100 crore in seed funding led by Bessemer Venture Partners at a ₹450 crore valuation. Mukesh Bansal has made a similar move. After building Myntra and Cult.fit for consumers, he is now building enterprise artificial intelligence (AI) start-up Nurix AI, selling to other businesses. Gupta declined to comment on this story. Bansal and Anant Vidur Puri, partner at Bessemer Venture Partners, did not